

Mozilla launches a ₹ 10 million fund to support open source projects in India

Mozilla has announced 'Global Mission Partners: India', an award programme that focuses on support for open source. The initiative is a part of the company's existing 'Mission Partners' program, and is aimed at supporting open source and free software projects in India with a total funding of ₹ 10 million.



The program is accepting applications from all over India. Also, Mozilla has agreed to support every project that furthers the company's mission. It has identified plenty of software projects in the country that need active backing. "Our mission, as embodied in our Manifesto, is to ensure the Internet is a global public resource, open and accessible to all; an Internet that truly puts people first, where individuals can shape their own experience and are empowered, safe and independent," the company wrote in a blog post.

The minimum incentive for each successful applicant in the 'Global Mission Partners: India' initiative is ₹ 125,000. However, applicants can win support of up to ₹ 5 million. The last date for applications (in English or Hindi) from the first batch of applicants for the award programme was September 30.

Participating projects need to have an OSI open source licence or an FSF free software licence. Also, the applicants must be based in India. You can read all the explicit conditions at Mozilla's wiki page.

The WSL is a compatibility layer to natively run Linux binary executives (in EFL format) natively on Windows. Microsoft originally introduced its WSL functionality with the Windows 10 Anniversary Update back in August 2016.

And now, it is bringing the same experience to Windows Server. The new move



also allows you to run open source developments such as Node.js, Ruby, Python, Perl and Bash scripts.

However, Microsoft has not provided native support for persistent Linux services like daemons and jobs as background tasks. You also need to enable the WSL and install a Linux distribution to begin with the advanced operations on Windows Server.

The new Windows Server test build comes with Remote Server Administration Tools (RSAT) packages. Users can install Windows 10 builds greater than 16250, to manage and administer insider builds using GUI tools with the help of RSAT packages.

You can additionally find new container images, optimised Nano Server base images, latest previews of .NET Core 2.0 and PowerShell 6.0, and a tweaked Server Core version. Also, the new release comes with various networking enhancements for Kubernetes integration and pipe mapping support. You need to register for the Windows Insiders for Business Program or Windows Insider Program to get your hands on the latest build of Windows Server. It includes various bug fixes and performance enhancements over the first preview build that was released earlier.

Oracle releases first beta of VirtualBox 5.2

Oracle has announced the first beta release of its upcoming VirtualBox 5.2. The new build comes with a feature to help users export VMs to the Oracle Public Cloud.



The new release of VirtualBox 5.2 eliminates all the hassle of exporting VMs to external drives and again importing to another VirtualBox installation. The company has also improved the handling of Virtual Machine Tools and Global Tools.

The first beta gives a glimpse of all the features that you will get to see in the stable release, and has a number of noteworthy improvements. The accessibility support in the GUI and EFI support have been enhanced in the new build. On the audio front, Oracle has added asynchronous data processing for HDA audio emulation. The audio support has also received host device callbacks, which will kick in while adding or removing an audio device.

In addition to the features limited to the beta version, Oracle is set to provide automatic, unattended guest OS installation in the next VirtualBox release. The fresh feature will be similar to the 'Easy Install' feature that was debuted on the commercial VMware Workstation 6.5 and 7 virtualisation software. The stable build will also improve the VM selector GUI. Similarly, users are expecting the upcoming releases to completely revamp the GUI on all supported platforms.

Ahead of the final release, you can download the VirtualBox 5.2 Beta 1 from the Oracle website to get a glimpse of the new additions. Users should note that this is a pre-release version and all its features may not be stable on supported systems.

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